PHISHING EMAIL DETECTION & AWARENESS SYSTEM

Task 02:

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What Are Phishing Indicators?

Phishing indicators are warning signs that help identify whether an email, message, or website is fake and designed to steal sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or personal data.

6-Step Process to Identify Phishing Emails

1. Check the Sender's Email Address

Look carefully at the sender's email.

Phishing emails often use addresses that look similar to real ones.

Example:

Fake: support@paypa1.com

Real: support@paypal.com

2. Look for Urgent or Threatening Language

Phishing emails try to create panic.

They may say:

“Your account will be suspended!”

“Immediate action required!”

Tip: Legitimate companies rarely pressure you urgently.

3. Check for Spelling and Grammar Mistakes

Many phishing emails contain:

Poor grammar

Spelling errors

Unprofessional formatting

Example:

“Dear user, your account has been block. Kindly update immediatly.”

4. Check for Generic Greetings

Phishing emails often use:

“Dear Customer”

“Dear User”

Legitimate emails usually use your name.

5. Look at Attachments and Links

Do not open unknown attachments.

Hover over links to check the real URL before clicking.

Warning Signs:

Shortened links

Mismatched URLs

Suspicious file types (.exe, .zip)

6. Compare Claims with Official Sources

Verify the message by visiting the official website.

Do not click links in suspicious emails.

Contact the company directly if unsure.

Example Analysis

Email Content:

“Your bank account will be locked! Click here to verify immediately.”

Analysis:

Urgent language ✓

Suspicious link ✓

Generic greeting ✓

Conclusion: This is likely a phishing email.

Easy Checklist (Use While Analyzing)

✓ Check sender email

✓ Look for urgency

✓ Check grammar mistakes

✓ Verify greeting

✓ Inspect links and attachments

✓ Confirm with official source

Pro Tip (For Higher Marks)

Always mention:

Multiple phishing indicators

Real-life examples

Clear explanation of each step

Conclusion

Phishing attacks are common but can be avoided by staying alert and checking for warning signs. Always verify emails before clicking links or sharing personal information.